



CONTINGENCY LESSONS

Reading for SylvanSync™

Intermediate



GRADES 6-8

TO BE USED ONLY IN CASE OF EMERGENCY, WITH THE APPROVAL OF TECHNOLOGY SERVICES.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Story Summary 1

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- write a summary of a fictional story.
- create flash cards for any unfamiliar vocabulary.
- study the new vocabulary words.

Materials

- index cards
- markers
- writing paper

Background Information

When you **summarize**, you use your own words to briefly retell the main ideas, events, or details from a story you have read. A summary contains only the most important details, so it is much shorter than the original.

Pausing to summarize as you read helps you check your comprehension before you read further. While reading the original story, take note of the questions: who, what, when, where, why, and how. Using these questions to examine what you are reading will help you to write the summary.

Summarizing is an effective strategy for reading any type of genre. Writing a summary will help you understand and remember what you have read.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Story Summary 1

Use these steps and tips to help you write a summary.

1. Read the story. Read with who, what, when, where, why, and how questions in mind.
2. Reread the story and underline important ideas. Circle key terms. Find the main idea.
3. Write a sentence that states the main idea of the story. This is the first thing to include in the summary.
4. You might want to use this format to help you. In "title of the story," "author" shows that "central idea of the story." The author supports the main idea by using _____ and showing that _____.
5. Write your rough draft and include the important ideas, key words, important data, and any important conclusions. Keep your summary short. Do not rewrite the original story. Use your own wording. Do not put in your opinion of the issue or topic discussed in the original story.
6. Edit your summary. Be concise. Eliminate needless words and repetitions.

This lesson is based on a genre of writing that comes from a writer's imagination. **Fiction** is prose writing that creates stories that tell about people, places, ideas, or events that are made up by the author. Examples of this genre are: novels, myths, fairy tales, and short stories. Some authors rely on their imaginations alone to create their fictional writing pieces. Others base their fictional stories on actual events and people, to which they add invented characters, dialogue, and plot situations.

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

Answer the following questions about the elements of a summary and fiction writing.

1. A summary will include all of the details on the original story.
 - a. true
 - b. false
2. A summary is written to briefly retell the main idea and important details of a story.
 - a. true
 - b. false
3. In a summary the title and the author of the story are included.
 - a. true
 - b. false
4. The main idea of the original story should be included at the end of the summary.
 - a. true
 - b. false
5. A fictional piece of writing includes imaginary characters and events.
 - a. true
 - b. false

Read the following paragraph and explain why it is a summary. Write your response on your writing paper.

During the war in 1781, a very brave girl saved her baby sister from a group of robbers that broke into her home. While the robbers were looting her home, the girl and her parents hid in the upstairs bedroom. Her parents soon realized that the girl's baby sister was still downstairs. The girl bravely crawled past the robbers to save her baby sister.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Story Summary 1

Part 3

Read the adapted short story “Jack Pumpkinhead and the Sawhorse” by L. Frank Baum. While you are reading, take notes on the main or important ideas, details or events, and unfamiliar vocabulary words.

Jack Pumpkinhead and the Sawhorse

In the Royal Palace hangs a Magic Picture; it shows the important scenes that transpire. Ozma, the girl Ruler, is able to discover events taking place in her kingdom.

One day she saw a little girl and boy had wandered into a great, gloomy forest and had become hopelessly lost. Their family was seeking them and unless Ozma came to their rescue the little ones would never be found.

The Princess asked Jack Pumpkinhead to come to the palace. He was an old friend of Ozma. His form was made of rough sticks fitted dressed in ordinary clothes. His head was a pumpkin with a face carved on it, and was set on top of a sharp stake which formed his neck. Jack was good-natured and a favorite; but his head was likely to spoil, so to secure a good supply of heads he grew a field of pumpkins and lived in the middle, his house, a huge pumpkin. When he needed a new head he picked a pumpkin, carved a face, and stuck it on the stake.

The day Ozma sent for Jack, he was in prime condition and was glad to be of service in rescuing the children. Ozma made a map, showing where the forest was and how to get to it and the paths. She said: "You'd better ride Sawhorse, he is swift and intelligent." This remarkable animal was not unlike Jack Pumpkinhead. Its body was a log, with four sticks stuck into it for legs. A branch at one end served as a tail, while in the other end was chopped a mouth. Above this were two small knots for eyes. Sawhorse was the favorite steed of Ozma and to prevent its wooden legs from wearing out she had them shod with plates of gold. Jack said "Good morning" to Sawhorse and placed on the creature's back a saddle of purple leather, studded with jewels. He climbed on the saddle and the animal pranced out of the stable, and out on the highway leading to the forest. Jack examined the map and found the right path. The paths branched so many times and in so many ways that Pumpkinhead was obliged to consult Ozma's map, and finally Sawhorse became suspicious. "Are you sure you are right?" it asked. "Of course," answered Jack. "Even a Pumpkinhead whose brains are seeds

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Story Summary 1

can follow a map. Every path is marked, and here is a cross where the children are."

Finally they came upon the lost children. They found the children bound fast to the trunk of a tree. The girl was sobbing bitterly and the boy was trying to comfort her. "Cheer up, my dears," said Jack. "I have come to take you back to your family. But why are you bound to that tree?"

"Because," cried a small, sharp voice, "they are thieves. That's why!" "Dear me!" said Jack, looking around to see who had spoken. A big gray squirrel was sitting on a branch. On the squirrel's head was a circle of gold, with a diamond in the center. He was running up and down the limbs and chattering excitedly. "These children," said the squirrel, angrily, "robbed all the nuts we had saved for winter. Being King of the Squirrels, I ordered them arrested."

"We were hungry," said the boy, pleadingly, "we found a hollow tree full of nuts, and ate them to keep alive." "Quite right," remarked Jack, nodding his pumpkin head. "I don't blame you." He began to untie the ropes. His wooden fingers were awkward. When at last he succeeded, the tree was full of squirrels. From the tree they hurled nuts at Pumpkinhead. At the top of this tree was a dead limb, and so many squirrels gathered on it that suddenly it broke and fell. Jack was standing under it and when the limb struck it smashed his head into a pulpy mass. When he felt for his head it was gone. He could not see; neither could he speak. The squirrels danced around in the tree in great glee as they saw Jack's plight. Sawhorse said to the children, "Pick up Pumpkinhead's body and set it on my saddle. Then mount behind and hold on. We must get out of this forest, or the squirrels may recapture you." Sawhorse, Pumpkinhead, and the children moved back along the path. Toward evening they came upon a fruit tree, which furnished the children supper.

Ozma had seen in her Magic Picture all that had happened, so she sent the little Wizard, mounted on Cowardly Lion, to save the unfortunates. The Lion knew the forest and when he reached it he bounded straight through the paths to where they were wandering. The Wizard grieved at the sight of headless Jack, but believed he could save him. He led Sawhorse out of the forest and restored the boy and girl to their family.

The Wizard mounted Sawhorse and supported Jack's form on the ride to the pumpkin field. When they arrived at Jack's house the Wizard selected

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Story Summary 1

a pumpkin—not too ripe—and carved a face. He stuck the pumpkin on Jack's neck and asked, "Well, old friend, how do you feel?" "Fine!" replied Jack. "You have saved my life."

"Are the brains in the new head any better than the old ones?" inquired Sawhorse, who had watched Jack's restoration. "Why, the seeds are quite tender," replied the Wizard, "so they will give our friend tender thoughts. To speak truly, my dear Sawhorse, Jack Pumpkinhead, with all his good qualities, will never be noted for his wisdom."

Now answer these questions.

1. What is the main idea of this story?
 - a. People's good qualities should be respected by others.
 - b. It is not wrong to ask for help when you don't understand.
 - c. Doing as you are told by your superiors is the correct action.
 - d. It is more important to be intelligent and wise than to be kind to others.
2. How do you know that this story is fictional?
 - a. The story describes imaginary events.
 - b. The story includes real ideas and people.
 - c. The story outlines the sequence of events.
 - d. The story establishes the author's point of view.
3. Who helped Pumpkin head get a head?
 - a. Jack
 - b. Ozma
 - c. Sawhorse
 - d. Wizard

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Story Summary 1

4. What will Jack probably do the next time Ozma needs him to make a rescue?
 - a. He will ask for the Wizard to help him.
 - b. He will do exactly as Ozma directs him to do.
 - c. He will not sit under a tree with dead branches.
 - d. He will refuse the request and return to his field.
5. What is the meaning of the word transpire as it is used in the first paragraph?
 - a. emit
 - b. escape
 - c. occur
 - d. reveal

Part 4

1. Using the index cards, create flash cards for any unfamiliar vocabulary that you identified in the short story in Part 3. Write the unfamiliar word on one side and the definition on the other side.
2. Now create a crossword puzzle on your writing paper to help you practice these vocabulary words.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Story Summary 1

Part 5

Write a summary of the fictional story you read in Part 3 on your writing paper. Make sure that your response includes the elements of a summary. Your writing will be evaluated using the following 3-point rubric.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Summary Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses all characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the summary.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the summary.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of a summary.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the summary.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Story Summary 2

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- write a summary of a fictional story.
- create flash cards for unfamiliar vocabulary words.
- study the new vocabulary words.

Materials

- index cards
- markers
- writing paper

Background Information

When you **summarize**, you use your own words to briefly retell the main ideas, events, or details from a story you have read. A summary contains only the most important details, so it is much shorter than the original.

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Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Story Summary 2

Use these steps and tips to help you write a summary.

1. Read the story. Read with who, what, when, where, why, and how questions in mind.
2. Reread the story and underline important ideas. Circle key terms. Find the main idea.
3. Write a sentence that states the main idea of the story. This is the first thing to include in the summary.
4. You might want to use this format to help you. In "title of the story," "author" shows that "central idea of the story." The author supports the main idea by using _____ and showing that _____.
5. Write your rough draft and include the important ideas, key words, important data, and any important conclusions. Keep your summary short. Do not rewrite the original story. Use your own wording. Do not put in your opinion of the issue or topic discussed in the original story.
6. Edit your summary. Be concise. Eliminate needless words and repetitions.

This lesson is based on a genre of writing that comes from a writer's imagination. **Fiction** is prose writing that creates stories that tell about people, places, ideas, or events that are made up by the author. Examples of this genre are: novels, myths, fairy tales, and short stories. Some authors rely on their imaginations alone to create their fictional writing pieces. Others base their fictional stories on actual events and people, to which they add invented characters, dialogue, and plot situations.

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

Answer the following questions about the elements of a summary and fiction writing.

1. A summary will include all of the details on the original story.
 - a. true
 - b. false
2. A summary is written to briefly retell the main idea and important details of a story.
 - a. true
 - b. false
3. In a summary the title and the author of the story are included.
 - a. true
 - b. false
4. The main idea of the original story should be included at the end of the summary.
 - a. true
 - b. false
5. A fictional piece of writing includes imaginary characters and events.
 - a. true
 - b. false

Read the following paragraph and explain why it is a summary. Write your response on your writing paper.

During the war in 1781, a very brave girl saved her baby sister from a group of robbers who broke into her home. While the robbers were looting her home, the girl and her parents hid in the upstairs bedroom. Her parents soon realized that the girl's baby sister was still downstairs. The girl bravely crawled past the robbers to save her baby sister.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Story Summary 2

Part 3

Read the ancient myth “Pandora’s Box.” While you are reading, take notes on the main or important ideas, important details or events, and unfamiliar vocabulary words.

Pandora’s Box

Zeus, ruler of all the gods, was angry and wanted to take revenge on humans. Zeus asked his son Hephaestus to create a woman, and so he did. The woman was blessed with many gifts from the other gods, such as beauty, musical talent, and persuasive abilities. The gods were proud of their creation and called her Pandora, meaning “gift-of-all.”

Finally, it was Zeus's turn to present his gift to Pandora. He gave her the gift of curiosity and a jar she was warned not to open under any circumstances.

Sometime afterward, Pandora married Epimetheus, and they lived happily together. One thing always bothered Pandora, though—the jar Zeus had given her. Every day she would walk by the jar, racked with curiosity about its contents.

The jar was sealed, and from the outside it looked like nothing special. Pandora continually wondered why Zeus would give her a jar that she was not supposed to open. The contents must be extremely precious and valuable, she thought.

At last, curiosity got the best of Pandora. She pulled and tugged at the jar until, finally, she pried the lid off. Pandora immediately regretted her action of weakness as she watched a cloud of evils fly out of the jar. Envy, spite, disease, revenge, anxiety, and misfortune swarmed around her head and then out into the world to plague humankind forever.

Just when she thought nothing else remained in the jar, Pandora closed the lid and sighed deeply. When she looked into the jar again, she noticed there was one thing left. Hope remained, in order to give people the ability to endure all the evils in the world.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Story Summary 2

Now answer these questions.

1. What is the main idea of this myth?
 - e. Only hope can save humanity.
 - f. Greed causes humans to learn about misfortunes.
 - g. Humans normally regret the results of the actions.
 - h. It is important to understand the possible results of your actions.
2. How do you know that this myth is fictional?
 - a. The story describes imaginary characters.
 - b. The story outlines the sequence of events.
 - c. The story includes historical ideas and people.
 - d. The story establishes the author's point of view.
3. Who did Pandora marry in the myth?
 - a. Aphrodite
 - b. Epimetheus
 - c. Hephaestus
 - d. Zeus
4. What will Pandora probably do the next time she is told not to touch something?
 - a. She will ask for the help of Zeus.
 - b. She will request that someone else touch it.
 - c. She will give it as a present to another person.
 - d. She will put the object in a place that it is not visible.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Story Summary 2

5. What is the meaning of the word racked as it is used in the third paragraph?
- a. to strain mentally
 - b. to strain physically
 - c. to torture physically
 - d. to be extremely cautious

Part 4

1. Using the index cards, create flash cards for any unfamiliar vocabulary that you identified in the short story in Part 3. Write the unfamiliar word on one side and the definition on the other side.
2. Now create a word search on your writing paper to help you practice these vocabulary words.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Story Summary 2

Part 5

Write a summary of the myth you read in Part 3 on your writing paper. Make sure that your response includes the elements of a summary. Your writing will be evaluated using the following 3-point rubric.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Summary Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses all characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the summary.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the summary.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of a summary.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the summary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- write a summary of a nonfiction article.
- create flash cards for unfamiliar vocabulary words.
- study the new vocabulary words.

Materials

- index cards
- writing paper

Background Information

When you **summarize**, you use your own words to briefly retell the main ideas, events, or details from a story you have read. A summary contains only the most important details, so it is much shorter than the original.

Pausing to summarize as you read helps you check your comprehension before you read further. While reading the original story, take note of the questions: who, what, when, where, why, and how. Using these questions to examine what you are reading will help you to write the summary.

Summarizing is an effective strategy for reading any type of genre. Writing a summary will help you understand and remember what you have read.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Use these steps and tips to help you write a summary.

1. Read the story. Read with who, what, when, where, why, and how questions in mind.
2. Reread the story and underline important ideas. Circle key terms. Find the main idea.
3. Write a sentence that states the main idea of the story. This is the first thing to include in the summary.
4. You might want to use this format to help you. In "title of the story," "author" shows that "central idea of the story." The author supports the main idea by using _____ and showing that _____.
5. Write your rough draft and include the important ideas, key words, important data, and any important conclusions. Keep your summary short. Do not rewrite the original story. Use your own wording. Do not put in your opinion of the issue or topic discussed in the original story.
6. Edit your summary. Be concise. Eliminate needless words and repetitions.

This lesson is based on a genre that is informative and factual. **Nonfiction** is prose writing that presents and explains ideas or that tells about real people, places, ideas, or events. To be classified as nonfiction, a work must be true. Examples of this genre are: newspaper stories, editorials, journals, and textbooks.

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

Answer the following questions about the elements of a summary and nonfiction writing.

1. A summary will include all of the details on the original article.
 - a. true
 - b. false
2. A summary is written to briefly retell the central point of an article.
 - a. true
 - b. false
3. In a summary, the title and the author are included.
 - a. true
 - b. false
4. The main idea of the original article should be included only at the very end of the summary.
 - a. true
 - b. false
5. A nonfiction article will include actual and real concepts.
 - a. true
 - b. false

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Part 2

Read the following paragraph and explain why it is a summary. Write your response on your writing paper.

Overall, the changes that have occurred in hockey have helped to improve the game. Hockey is faster and more exciting as a result of changes to the rules and the equipment in the past 120 years. Additionally, the players are more physically fit and athletic. For these reasons, modern hockey is a better game than hockey in the 1890s.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Part 3

Read the article “Lacrosse.” While you are reading, take notes on the main or important ideas, details or facts, and unfamiliar vocabulary words.

Lacrosse

The game we now know of as lacrosse may seem modern to you, but it has an extended history. Its heritage can be traced to the time when Native Americans played it. They used hair-stuffed deerskin balls. Each tribe had its own way of engaging in the sport. For example, in some tribes, players used two sticks. One stick was in each hand.

Cherokees had a very real-world use for the sport. They called it the “little brother of war” because it was considered such good military training. Modern-day teams have 12 players. In contrast, Cherokee teams could have had anywhere from 100 to over 2,000 players. It was common for an entire tribe to form one team. The goals could be positioned miles apart. Games sometimes continued three days.

The modern-day popularity of lacrosse in southern Ontario and upstate New York may be because of the Six Tribes of the Iroquois. They called their rendition of the game “baggataway” or “tewaraathon.” They played the game in a much systematized way. Only 12 to 15 players were allowed per team. The goals were set just 120 feet apart.

The first Europeans to witness the game being played were most likely French explorers. Before long, Europeans in Canada were participating in the game.

Today, lacrosse is played by many assemblies of people. Constance Applebee of England, who familiarized field hockey to America, helped institute lacrosse as a women's sport. As more people learn the game, lacrosse is projected to increase in popularity.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Now answer these questions.

1. What is the main idea of this article?
 - i. Women were the first to play lacrosse.
 - j. Lacrosse has a long history in North America.
 - k. A ball and stick are needed to play lacrosse.
 - l. Native Americans played lacrosse as a sport.
2. How do you know that this article is nonfiction?
 - a. The article includes factual information.
 - b. The article provides a humorous story.
 - c. The article outlines all the rules of the sport.
 - d. The article establishes a supported point of view.
3. Who were the first people to observe Native Americans playing lacrosse?
 - a. Canadians
 - b. English
 - c. French
 - d. New Yorkers
4. What is the author's opinion of what will happen to lacrosse?
 - a. Lacrosse is the best sport for women to play.
 - b. Learning lacrosse will help us to appreciate our heritage.
 - c. Only Native Americans should be permitted to play lacrosse.
 - d. People will enjoy participating in lacrosse as they learn to play it.

Reading for SylvanSync™**Grades 6–8****Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)**

5. What is the meaning of the word heritage as it is used in the first paragraph?
- a. account
 - b. history
 - c. interpretation
 - d. reputation

Part 4

1. Using the index cards, create flash cards for any unfamiliar vocabulary that you identified in the article in Part 3. Write the unfamiliar word on one card and the definition on a second index card.
2. Lay the flash cards face down on the table. Then turn one card up to read the word or the definition. Turn another card up to read the word or the definition. If they match, put them aside. If they don't match return them to the table, face down. Continue until you have matched up all of the cards.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 1 (Social Studies)

Part 5

Write a summary of the nonfiction passage you read in Part 3 on your writing paper. Make sure that your response includes the elements of a summary. Your writing will be evaluated using the following 3-point rubric.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Summary Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses all characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the summary.
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1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of a summary.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the summary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- write a summary of a nonfiction article.
- create flash cards for any unfamiliar vocabulary.
- study the new vocabulary words.

Materials

- index cards (or blank paper)
- markers
- writing paper

Background Information

When you **summarize**, you use your own words to briefly retell the main ideas, events, or details from an article you have read. A summary only tells the most important details, so it is much shorter than the original. But you do not omit every detail. A summary includes just enough detail to make the main idea or events clear.

Pausing to summarize as you read helps you check your comprehension before you read further. While reading the original article, take note of the questions: who, what, when, where, why, and how. Using these questions to examine what you are reading will help you to write the summary.

Summarizing is an effective strategy for reading any type of genre. Writing a summary will help you understand and remember what you have read.

For example, what might you include in a summary of a science report on a specific animal? To summarize the report, you would tell about the animal's habitat, life cycle, and food preferences. You would probably describe a few of the animal's primary characteristics, but you would not try to retell every characteristic. Your summary would be an abbreviated retelling in your own words.

At the same time, a summary must include enough information to be useful to the reader. What if you said, "The animal is small and likes to eat plants and lives in the woods"? The summary might be perfectly accurate, but it's too short to be useful to the reader because it includes too little information. Summaries should be helpful both to you as the reader of a passage and to the person who reads your summary.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Use these steps and tips to help you write a summary.

1. Read the article. Read with who, what, when, where, why, and how questions in mind.
2. Reread the article and underline important ideas. Circle key terms. Find the main idea.
3. Write a sentence that states the main idea of the article. This is the first thing in the summary.
4. You might want to use this format to help you. In "title of the article," "author" shows that "central idea of the article." The author supports the main idea by explaining that _____ and showing that _____.
5. Write your rough draft and include the important ideas, key words, important data, and any important conclusions. Keep your summary short. Do not rewrite the original article. Use your own wording. Do not put in your opinion of the issue or topic discussed in the original article.
6. Edit your summary. Be concise. Eliminate needless words and repetitions.

This lesson is based on a genre that is informative and factual. **Nonfiction** is prose writing that presents and explains ideas or that tells about real people, places, ideas, or events. To be classified as nonfiction, a work must be true. Examples of this genre are: newspaper stories, editorials, journals, and textbooks.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

Part 1

Answer the following questions about the elements of a summary and nonfiction writing.

1. A summary will include all of the details in the original article.
a. true b. false
2. A summary is written to briefly retell the central point of an article.
a. true b. false
3. In a summary of a nonfiction article, you should include the title and the author.
a. true b. false
4. The main idea of the original article should be included at the very end of the summary.
a. true b. false
5. A nonfiction article will include true concepts.
a. true b. false

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Part 2

Read the following summary and explain why it is a summary. Write your response on your writing paper.

The article “Protecting Wolves” by Cha Belle is about the wolves that were once extinct for more than 50 years. Currently, the Wyoming Wildlife Rescue Association members are studying the Seedskaadee National Wildlife Refuge because of the earlier information they gathered to make the case for giving the area permanent protection. That means restricted roads, logging, and no motorized vehicles in the wolves’ habitat. The Wyoming Wildlife Rescue Association members want to have more wolves in the community so they can have a variety of animals in the habitat, which will permit the food chain to flourish.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Part 3

Read the article “Mars.” While you are reading, create three lists: 1)the main or important ideas, 2)the details or facts, and 3)the unfamiliar vocabulary words.

Mars

Mars is the fourth planet from the Sun in our Solar System. We can see it easily in the nighttime sky because it shines red. People used to reflect that this red color was like anger and battle, so the planet was named for Mars, the Roman god of war.

Earth and Mars are very dissimilar from each other. Earth is about double the size of Mars. While Earth's year lasts only 365 days, the Martian year is 687 days long. Earth is mostly covered with water; on the other hand, scientists are still determining if there is any water on Mars. Both planets have seasons. It is colder on Mars than it is on Earth. In the winter, the temperature on Mars can drop to minus 207 degrees Fahrenheit.

The topography of Mars is filled with mountains, chasms, ridges, and knolls covering the surface of the planet. Vicious winds and titanic dust storms blow across Mars for months at a time. Mars looks red because there is a large quantity of rusted iron in the soil.

Mars's moons are Phobos and Deimos. Deimos is a tiny moon; in fact, it is the most diminutive of all the moons in the Solar System. It moves so speedily that it circles around Mars several times every day.

American scientists sent a spacecraft, the Mariner 4, to study Mars in 1965. The first craft to land on the planet was the Mars 2. In 1976, two Viking spacecrafts landed on Mars. On July 4, 1997, the Pathfinder landed. It sent back pictures and new evidence about the soil, air, and weather. This recent information has not yet answered the question of whether or not there is any form of life on the planet.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Now answer these questions.

1. What is the main idea of this article?
 - m. Legends explain the appearance of Mars.
 - n. Mars, its moons, and its exploration are explained.
 - o. Astronomers study the dissimilarities of Earth and Mars.
 - p. The existence of life on Mars has still not been explained.
2. How do you know that this article is nonfiction?
 - a. The article provides a humorous story.
 - b. The article includes factual information.
 - c. The article outlines all the rules of the sport.
 - d. The article establishes a supported point of view.
3. When did the first spacecraft land on Mars?
 - a. 1965
 - b. 1976
 - c. 1986
 - d. 1997
4. What is a possible prediction of what people will determine in the future about Mars?
 - a. Scientists will know how much water is on Mars.
 - b. Scientists will better understand the moon Phobos.
 - c. Scientists will be able to determine more about minerals in the ground.
 - d. Scientists will eventually become disinterested in Mars due to the lack of evidence.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

5. What is the meaning of the word dissimilar as it is used in the second paragraph?
- a. couple
 - b. individual
 - c. unlike
 - d. ultimate

Part 4

1. Using the index cards, create flash cards for any unfamiliar vocabulary that you identified in the article in Part 3. Write the unfamiliar word on one card and the definition on a second index card.
2. Lay the flash cards in a row with the definitions face up on the table. Take the cards with the words and match them by putting the word card on top of the correct definition until you have matched all the cards. Now reverse the cards. Lay the flash cards with the words face up and match with the definitions.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Nonfiction Article Summary 2 (Science)

Part 5

Write a summary of the nonfiction passage you read in Part 3 on your writing paper. Make sure that your response includes the elements of a summary. Your writing will be evaluated using the following 3-point rubric.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Summary Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses all characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the summary.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the summary.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of a summary.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the summary.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Drama

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- Describe the features and functions of the elements of a play.
- Read a play part "in character," using expressive oral reading.
- Write an additional scene for a play.

Materials

- writing paper
- pen or pencil

Background Information

A **play** is a story written with the intention of being performed by actors on a stage. The story is written as a **script**. The author, or playwright, uses dialogue spoken by the characters to advance the plot. The **playwright** or **dramatist** provides instructions about how a play should be performed through **stage directions**. These are instructions to the performers or descriptions to the reader that are separated from the **dialogue** by parentheses or brackets.

Like other prose, plays have **characters** who take part in the action of the story. The main characters face a **conflict**, or struggle, that moves the sequence of events called the **plot**.

The ancient Greeks developed plays or dramas into two basic categories. These categories are still used today to categorize plays. The first is a **tragedy**, which deals with the downfall of the main character. The other is a **comedy**, which is a play that has a happy ending. The primary difference between a tragedy and a comedy is the ending.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Drama

Use this chart to help you better understand the features and functions of a play.

Features and Function of a Play

Features	Functions
Acts	The primary organization of a play. A play may have one or more acts.
Scenes	An act is divided into one or more scenes. A scene moves the action to a new setting or time of day, or introduces a new character.
Stage Directions	Instructions about how a play should be performed. Usually set in italics and/or set off by brackets. These include background information about the setting or characters.
Character	Person being played by an actor or actress in the play.
Dialogue	Conversation; the spoken words between two or more characters.
Monologue	A long speech delivered by one character.
Soliloquy	A speech delivered by a character speaking to him or herself; this lets the audience know the character's inner thoughts and struggles.
Aside	A quick remark, often humorous, by a character to the audience rather than to the other characters.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Drama

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

Part 1

Read Act One, Scene One of the play *Closing the Sale*.

Closing the Sale

Cast

Amy Steele, the owner of the antiques store

Conrad Claypoole, a wealthy customer

Rex Karz, parking lot attendant

The interior of Steele's Antiques Store after 8:00 pm.

(Steele and Claypoole are the only people in the store.)

Steele: We could argue about price all evening, Mr. Claypoole, but the fact remains that you want this table.

Claypoole: *(Obviously irritated)* I may want this table, Madam, but I do not intend to spend \$3,000 on it.

Steele: And I do not intend to give this table away.

(The front door to the store opens. Karz enters from the street.)

Karz: All right, buddy. It's 8:00. The garage is closed, and you have to remove your car.

Claypoole: *(Becoming angry)* Can't you see that I'm busy?

Karz: I'm busy, too. In five minutes I'll be busy driving home and your car will be locked in our garage overnight.

Steele: *(Sweetly)* Mr. Claypoole, I will be happy to help you put this table in your car, and you'll be on your way.

Karz: *(Walks to the front door and opens it)* You've got four minutes, buddy.

Claypoole: *(Defeated)* All right. Charge the table to my account. Just let me get out of here.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Drama

Identify the following features in the play. Then on your paper, write the name of the feature and the example you identified.

- Stage directions
- Character
- Dialogue
- Setting
- Conflict

Part 2

Based on Act One, Scene One in the play *Closing the Sale*, answer the following questions.

1. What do the stage directions in this line tell you about the character?

Steele: (*Sweetly*) Mr. Claypoole, I will be happy to help you put this table in your car, and you'll be on your way.

2. Why does the playwright include this information at the beginning of the scene?

The interior of Steele's Antiques Store after 8:00 pm.

3. Why does the playwright include the list of names at the beginning of the scene?
4. Why does the playwright write the separate lines for each character throughout the scene?
5. What is the purpose of the conflict in this scene?

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Drama

Part 3

Answer the following questions based on Act One, Scene Two of *Closing the Sale*.

1. Why do you think that all of the characters seem to be angry or frustrated?
2. What would you probably see on the stage in this scene?
3. What could be added to the stage directions to better help the reader understand the setting of the play?
4. Write an aside that could be added to this line from the play.

Steele: And I do not intend to give this table away.

5. What do you predict could happen in Scene Two of this play?

Part 4

Practice reading to yourself Scene One of *Closing the Sale*. Think about how each of the characters would sound and look reading their lines. Be prepared to be "in character" by using expressive oral reading of this scene.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Drama

Part 5

Now it is your turn to be a playwright. Write Scene Two for Act One of *Closing the Sale*. Make sure that you include the appropriate elements of a play. Your writing will be evaluated using the following 3-point rubric. Write your scene on your paper.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of the Scene	Uses Features of a Play Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the scene exactly.	Uses many of the appropriate features of a play in the scene.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the scene.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the scene but wanders a bit.	Uses a few appropriate features of a play.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the scene.
1	Does not address the structure of the scene at all.	Does not use appropriate features of a play.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the scene.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Op-Ed Essay

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- distinguish facts from opinions.
- analyze the author's argument.
- write an opinion piece for a local newspaper.

Materials

- writing paper

Background Information

The ability to read, view, and listen critically are important skills that you will use throughout your life. You need to be able to analyze and interpret information intelligently. To read critically, you must be able to judge if the information in text, advertisements, or other media is factual, or merely the opinion of an individual.

A **fact** is something that you can prove by conducting research or consulting a reliable source such as an encyclopedia or a reliable website. This information is something that can be verified by establishing accuracy with a source. For example: “That house was painted yellow in 2010.” This can be verified by obtaining the receipt for the paint or the painter's invoice for the work.

An **opinion** is an individual's belief, feeling, or inference. Opinions are based on feeling, not facts. For example: “Yellow is a better color for houses than green because yellow is more soothing and friendly.” This is a personal judgment, not a fact. Some people might disagree with this statement because they have different feelings or beliefs. The statement cannot be proven, and all cannot agree upon it. Therefore, it is an opinion.

It is important to be able to tell the difference between facts and opinions in nonfiction writing. Nonfiction writing is about real events and the world in which we live. Nonfiction writing includes:

- newspaper articles
- personal essays
- research

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Op-Ed Essay

Some nonfiction passages provide only factual information. Others offer opinions or judgments. These are written for the purpose of persuading the reader to accept a particular point of view or to take a certain action. It is important to remember that opinions can be present in nonfiction writing. Likewise, facts may be present in statements of opinion. What you as a critical reader need to ask yourself is whether or not the statement can be proven and whether there are people who would disagree with the statement.

A helpful way to determine if a statement is a fact or an opinion is to look for words that the writer or speaker uses. Words used in a factual statement can include dates and numbers, and are specific. Words that signal or indicate an opinion are often words that suggest or exaggerate.

This chart lists some signal words that can help you to differentiate between facts and opinions.

Fact	Opinion
verified	best
documented	favorite
research	always
statistics	most
according	should
official	never
studies	believe

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Op-Ed Essay

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

Part 1

Fact/opinion sort: Read the following sentences. On a sheet of paper, draw a two-column chart like the one below. Write the number of the sentence in the “Fact” column if the sentence expresses a fact, and write the number of the sentence in the “Opinion” column if the sentence expresses an opinion.

1. All people are always afraid of hurricanes.
2. The months of August and September have the most hurricanes.
3. The hurricane was a category 1 when it made landfall.
4. People should evacuate when there is a hurricane.
5. I believe that hurricanes are never as bad as they are reported to be.
6. Winds ahead of the hurricane had begun to increase.
7. It would be best if you listened to the television reports.
8. It was an unlucky day for the town.
9. The hurricane caused millions of dollars of damage.
10. Surfers flocked to their favorite beaches as the waves increased.

Fact	Opinion

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Op-Ed Essay

Part 2

Think of taking a vacation to a beach.

What are some other facts about the beach? On a sheet of paper, write four facts about a beach vacation.

What is your opinion about a beach vacation? On your paper, write two opinions about a beach vacation.

Part 3

First identify the sentence as a fact or opinion by writing “Fact” or “Opinion” on your paper. Then, if the sentence is an opinion, rewrite it as a fact. If the sentence is a fact, rewrite it as an opinion.

1. I actually thought that the writing assignment was quite easy.
2. The author’s writing has always been considered to be great.
3. After studying poetry we will study drama.
4. The students were expected to read 25 novels this year.
5. The writing contest is unfair to new writers.

Part 4

Read the following passage.

The school day is entirely too long. Many students must be at school as early as 7:30 in the morning. School days for many students run as long as eight hours. Children of all ages have a short attention span and a great deal of energy, and they cannot be expected to remain seated for long periods of time as many classes require.

Even after school, children are constantly burdened with homework. Children have little playtime anymore and are expected to “hit the books” for an extensive period of time. Children are given little time to be children—carefree, playful, and imaginative. This can only harm them in the long run.

Government officials are talking about extending the school day so that more subjects can be added. Children, however, have 12 years of schooling to cover all those subjects already. If they aren’t enrolled in a class one year, then enroll them in that subject the next year. If students can’t learn enough in school in the entire seven to eight hours that they are

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Op-Ed Essay

already there, then perhaps it is the instruction that needs to change and not the length of the school day.

I propose that the school day be shortened instead. Provide students the time to participate in hobbies, sports, and other enjoyable events. Give them more time to spend with their families. Give them time to discover teamwork and sportsmanship outside of the school building. Give them time to socialize with children other than those they sit with day in and day out.

We will all be better off if we produce well-balanced children rather than children who are suffocated by our school systems.

Now on a sheet of paper, draw a two-column chart like the one below. In this chart, write four opinions and four facts from the passage.

Opinions	Facts

Then, on your paper write one to two sentences that explain whether the writer sufficiently supports his or her argument.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Op-Ed Essay

Part 5

Write an article for your local newspaper expressing your opinions of the use of cell phones in public places such as restaurants and movie theaters. Make sure that you support your opinions with facts. Your writing will be evaluated using the following 3-point rubric. Write your article on your paper.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate facts to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few facts to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate facts to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Blog

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- summarize a blog entry.
- describe how the writer tries to persuade the reader.
- write a blog entry.

Materials

- writing paper

Background Information

When you **summarize**, you use your own words to briefly retell the main ideas, events, or details from an article you have read. A summary includes only the most important details, so it is much shorter than the original. But you do not omit every detail. A summary includes just enough detail to make the main idea or events clear.

Pausing to summarize as you read helps you check your comprehension before you read further. While reading the original article, take note of the questions: who, what, when, where, why, and how. Using these questions to examine what you are reading will help you to write the summary. Summarizing is an effective strategy for reading any type of text. Writing a summary will help you understand and remember what you have read.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Blog

Use these steps and tips to help you write a summary.

1. Read the article. Read with who, what, when, where, why, and how questions in mind.
2. Reread the article and underline important ideas. Circle key terms. Find the main idea.
3. Write a sentence that states the main idea of the article. This is the first thing in the summary.
4. You might want to use this format to help you. In "title of the article," "author" shows that "central idea of the article." The author supports the main idea by explaining that _____ and showing that _____.
5. Write your rough draft and include the important ideas, key words, important data, and any important conclusions. Keep your summary short. Do not rewrite the original article. Use your own wording. Do not put in your opinion of the issue or topic discussed in the original article.
6. Edit your summary. Be concise. Eliminate needless words and repetitions.

Blogs have become a basic part of the online culture. Practically everyone reads blogs, whether they're "official" news blogs from traditional news media, topic-based blogs related to one's work or hobbies, or blogs purely for entertainment. Just about anyone you ask has at least one favorite blog. They are used by millions of people to write and share anything that comes to mind on a regular basis.

Blogging is the keeping of an online journal or diary. In this journal, a person writes about a subject that they are passionate about or have an interest in. Other people from around the world will then provide feedback responding to your writing on the subject.

Blogs have a relatively short history. It's only in the past five to ten years that they've really taken off. It wasn't until 1997 that the term "weblog" was used. Weblog was then shortened to "blog" sometime around 1999. Five years later Merriam-Webster declared the word their word of the year.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Blog

These tips and ideas will help you write and maintain your blog.

1. Write often: Try to write at least once a week.
2. Keep notes: When you actually sit down to write, you will have two or three ideas based on your notes.
3. Have a time to write: This is very personal. You might write better in the morning, or you might write better in the evening.
4. Contribute to the conversation: It's important to say something new and interesting.
5. Be yourself: Ideally you want to say something interesting. Just be yourself. Some of the best blogs are the ones that are unique and highly personal. There will always be an audience in the blogosphere.
6. Use pictures: Pictures, cartoons, and illustrations are essential.

With the advent of social media and networking in the past five years, blogs have become only one portion of an individual's online personality. Blogs are unlikely to disappear in the future.

Reading for SylvanSync™ Grades 6–8 Blog

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

Part 1

Answer the following questions about the elements of a summary and a blog.

1. A summary will include all of the details of the original article.
 - a. true
 - b. false
2. A summary is written to briefly retell the central point of an article.
 - a. true
 - b. false
3. If possible, you should include the title and the author in a summary of a text.
 - a. true
 - b. false
4. The main idea of the original article should be included only at the end of the summary.
 - a. true
 - b. false
5. A blog always includes the writer's name, address, and phone number.
 - a. true
 - b. false

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Blog

Part 2

Read the blog entry “Sea Kayaking in Nova Scotia.” As you read, take notes on the main or important ideas, details or facts, and unfamiliar vocabulary words.

Sea Kayaking in Nova Scotia

My name is Patricia and I barely swim. There is a chance, I think, I could swim to save my life. This is based on a traumatic childhood memory involving swim lessons. So when it comes to swimming, there are a few basics that never really became second nature to me. Basically, even though I am in good shape, I can’t make it to the other end of a pool.

It is a bit strange, my fear of swimming, since I love the ocean. And when I travel, my utter fear of putting myself in a situation in which drowning is a very real possibility, seems to fade. When I travel, I’m truly adventurous.

One of the things that I absolutely had to do before leaving Nova Scotia was sea kayaking. When I was asking advice on things to do in Nova Scotia, the incredibly helpful Nikki from Seacoast Adventures—who is, in my opinion, an incredible ambassador for all of Nova Scotia—recommended Nova Scotia Coastal Outfitters, which is about 30 minutes east of Halifax. I didn’t think twice and booked it.

After some quick photos, we geared up, got into our kayaks and began paddling...

Before getting too far from the dock, our guide, Michelle, gave us a quick lesson on how to approach the wind, how to turn the kayaks efficiently, and what to do if we flipped. This little lesson was much appreciated because the waters that day were beginning to look a bit treacherous, well at least to me. Okay, that’s dramatic, but I will say that most of our trip was spent fighting the wind, and it included a couple of last-minute direction changes so that we wouldn’t be swept far out into the Atlantic Ocean. Surprisingly, I wasn’t scared at all; it was exhilarating. In fact, as we floated through the semi-choppy waters I almost felt invincible and serene.

Then, out of nowhere, a little gust of wind crept in—and my reverie and serenity were eliminated. After stopping at a sheltered little beach for a lunch break (our tour was planned to be about four hours long), my friend

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Blog

Jerry's kayak flipped while he was waiting for the rest of the group to get back into the water. The wind caught his paddle at just the right angle and it was enough to send him over. He was probably upside down for less than five seconds but that five seconds were the scariest seconds of my life. My entire body went numb and I almost flipped my own kayak.

Okay, again that's dramatic. We were so near to shore that Jerry simply stood up after crawling out of his kayak to get a breath of air. Once he got back in we all set off for the return journey.

Thanks to Jerry, whose bravery extended beyond his little mishap (he had brought his camera at the risk of it getting wet), we got some nice action shots...

In the end, Jerry didn't drown, I didn't have a heart attack from watching him potentially drown, and despite the flip, Jerry's camera made it out okay.

If given the chance to paddle with Nova Scotia Coastal Outfitters again, I would do it in a heartbeat.

Now answer these questions.

1. What is the main idea of this blog?
 - q. People should learn the basics of a sport.
 - r. Being on the ocean in a boat can be dangerous.
 - s. A person should find a way to overcome their fears.
 - t. Having an adventure is part of the excitement of travel.
2. Who recommended Nova Scotia Coastal Outfitters?
 - a. Jerry
 - b. Michelle
 - c. Nikki
 - d. Patricia

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Blog

3. What do you think the writer of the blog will do the next time she goes to the ocean on a trip?
 - a. She will take swimming lessons first.
 - b. She will book another kayak adventure.
 - c. She will stay ashore since she is fearful of the water.
 - d. She will take a motorboat ride rather than a kayak trip.
4. What is the meaning of the word ambassador as it is used in the third paragraph?
 - a. authorized representative
 - b. compassionate chaperone
 - c. permanent inhabitant
 - d. trusted collaborator
5. How does the writer of the blog try to persuade the reader?
 - a. by supporting her point of view with details
 - b. by providing details of the ocean adventure
 - c. by portraying herself like any ordinary person
 - d. by explaining her fear and how she overcame it

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Blog

Part 3

Write a summary of the blog entry you read in Part 2 on your writing paper. Make sure that your response includes the elements of a summary. Your writing will be evaluated using the following 3-point rubric.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Summary Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses all characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the summary.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of a summary.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the summary.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of a summary.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the summary.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Blog

Part 4

Write a blog entry that describes your thoughts and concerns about an environmental issue. Be sure to include personal experiences and to write in your own voice. Write your entry on your writing paper. Make sure that your response includes persuasive techniques to be convincing. Your writing will be evaluated using the following 3-point rubric.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of a blog	Uses Persuasive Techniques Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the blog exactly.	Uses a persuasive technique in the blog.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the blog.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the blog but wanders a bit.	Uses some of the persuasive technique in the blog.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the blog.
1	Does not address the structure of the blog at all.	Does not use a persuasive technique in the blog.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the blog.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Print Advertisement

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- analyze the persuasive techniques of three print advertisements.
- create a print advertisement for one of the products.
- compare and contrast the new ad with the three print ads.

Materials

- paper
- markers
- writing paper

Background Information

Advertisements inform people about new products. The goal of the advertiser is to persuade people to buy a particular product. Continued use of the advertisement is to remind and encourage people to repeat their purchase of the product.

Persuasion in advertising is about convincing the buyer that they really want or need to get the product. Advertisers use opinions and general statements to convince people to purchase.

The strategies an advertiser uses to persuade buyers are **propaganda techniques**. Advertisements use these techniques to influence. The more aware you are of the techniques advertisers use to persuade, the better you can judge whether their argument for purchasing the product is good.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Print Advertisement

Use the following chart to review the most common types of propaganda techniques used in advertising.

Persuasive Technique	Definition	Example
Bandwagon	suggesting that everyone is using the product	"Over one thousand local teenagers have enjoyed eating at Bruno's."
Card Staking	showing only one side of an argument for a product	"Eight out of ten nurses recommend Flexible Bandages for their patients."
Glittering Generalities	using important-sounding but unclear or false claims about a product	"Lily Smith has the right stuff. Vote Smith for President."
Loaded Words	using words that give a certain feeling about the product; words can be either positive or negative	Positive: new, improved, amazing Negative: terrible, boring, uninteresting
Plain Folks	linking the use of the product with ordinary people with whom the buyer can relate	"I am a mom just like you, and I always take my kids to Fit Zone."
Testimonial	using stars to endorse a product to make it appear attractive	"I'm a famous actress, and I eat Fruity Yogurt."
Transfer	linking a product with a feeling that people want or enjoy	"SunGlow leaves hair as fresh and silky as a puppy's new coat."

Analysis of advertising includes making **comparisons** and **contrasts**. Comparisons show similarities between people, objects, and events. Contrasts show the differences. Being able to compare and contrast advertisements requires you to understand how the advertisers use persuasive techniques.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Print Advertisement

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

Part 1

Write the name of the persuasive technique that is used in each sentence.

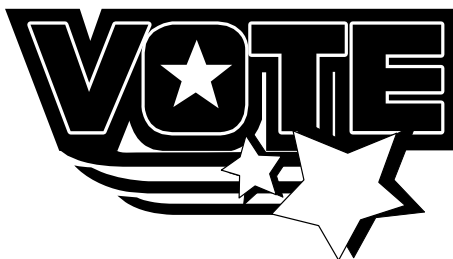
1. Pure, fresh, mountain river water. Bottled just for you in Montana from only the purest of the mountain rivers.
2. Fruity Chocolate Covered Oat Cereal is low in fat and high in fiber.
3. Get off your knees and use “Sparkling Bright” so cleaning your kitchen floor is a breeze.
4. Soccer great Nancy Finton wears Lightening Athletic shoes.
5. Commuters just like you love the new LinkPass!
6. This incredible, amazing new golf club is sure to improve your scores.
7. Everyone is running to the malls to buy the latest CD, *MiSSing U*.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Print Advertisement

Part 2

Read the following advertisements, and write the word(s) that indicate the persuasive technique used. There could be more than one. Next to the words, write the name of the persuasive technique.

Advertisement 1



Henry Bonfriend
For Class President



**Everyone likes a FRIEND! Everyone is
VOTING for Henry Bonfriend!**

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Print Advertisement

Advertisement 2

People just like you use Fluffy Dryer sheets in each load.



Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Print Advertisement

Advertisement 3

Buy the new kit, “Amazing Magic Tricks”



Who knows what incredible fun YOU will have!

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Print Advertisement

Part 3

Now it is your turn to be an advertiser. Create an advertisement for one of the products advertised in the three advertisements. You may use writing paper or paper and markers. Make sure that you include at least one persuasive technique in your advertisement. Your advertisement will be evaluated using the following 3-point rubric.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of the Advertisement	Uses Persuasive Techniques Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the advertisement exactly.	Uses a persuasive technique in the advertisement.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the advertisement.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the advertisement but wanders a bit.	Uses some of the persuasive technique in the advertisement.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the advertisement.
1	Does not address the structure of the advertisement at all.	Does not use a persuasive technique in the advertisement.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the advertisement.

Part 4

Compare and contrast the advertisement that you created with the three original advertisements. How are the persuasive techniques similar or different? Which advertisement is more effective and why? Write your answers on your writing paper.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Poem

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- evaluate the use of figurative language in a poem.
- analyze the meaning of a poem.
- write your own poem in a similar style.

Materials

- writing paper

Background Information

Writers and poets often want to make their writing interesting for the reader. They will do this by using words to illustrate clear and creative images in the reader's mind. To do this, writers use different types of **figurative language**.

The two most well-known types of figurative language are **similes** and **metaphors**. These types of figurative language are used by a poet or an author to compare two unlike things. Similes make direct comparisons, using the words like or as. Metaphors, however, make indirect comparisons and will often attempt to substitute another thing for the real subject.

Authors use **personification** to give human characteristics or traits to animals or objects. Authors may choose to make an object seem alive or an animal seem human. Personification can be humorous, or it can show how we see ourselves in the world around us.

Two types of figurative language that are useful in helping the reader "hear" what the writer describes are **onomatopoeia** and **alliteration**.

Idioms are expressions that don't literally mean exactly what they say. Another expression that cannot be interpreted at the literal level is a **hyperbole**. A hyperbole is an obvious exaggeration. Hyperbole can sound like a simile, but it differs because of the obvious exaggeration.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Poem

Use the following chart to help you remember the seven types of figurative language.

Type of Figurative Language	Definition	Example
Simile	a comparison of two unlike things using either "like" or "as"	His eyes were like beacons of light.
Metaphor	a comparison of two unlike things without using the words "like" or "as"	The grass was a shaggy green carpet.
Personification	giving a non-human thing human qualities	The waves danced in glee along the shore.
Idiom	a saying that means something different than the literal definition of the individual words	She tried to make ends meet.
Hyperbole	an exaggerated statement that makes the reader have an emotional response	My backpack weighs a ton!
Alliteration	the repetition of a beginning consonant sound to create a feeling or add a musical or rhythmic feeling to the text	The fiery fearsome foe forced itself forward.
Onomatopoeia	a word that imitates the sound it represents	phew, ping, plop, poof, purr

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Poem

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

Part 1

Read each sentence. For each one, write the type of figurative language that is used.

1. In the dark of night we sat by the crackling fire.
2. We could hear the wind yelling at the height of the storm.
3. The child was as agile as a monkey when playing on the bars.
4. The girl appeared to have a huge chip on her shoulder.
5. The wind whined wildly when we watched the storm from inside.
6. Her gorgeous smile was a mile wide when her braces were removed.
7. All of the students agreed that the writing assignment was a breeze.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Poem

Part 2

Read the excerpt of the poem “The Bells” by Edgar Allan Poe.

The Bells

I.

Hear the sledges with the bells—
Silver bells!
What a world of merriment their melody foretells!
How they tinkle, tinkle, tinkle,
In the icy air of night!
While the stars that oversprinkle
All the heavens seem to twinkle
With a crystalline delight;
Keeping time, time, time,
In a sort of Runic rhyme,
To the tintinnabulation that so musically wells
From the bells, bells, bells, bells,
Bells, bells, bells—
From the jingling and the tinkling of the bells.

II.

Hear the mellow wedding bells—
Golden bells!
What a world of happiness their harmony foretells!
Through the balmy air of night
How they ring out their delight!
From the molten-golden notes,
And all in tune,
What a liquid ditty floats
To the turtle-dove that listens, while she gloats
On the moon!
Oh, from out the sounding cells
What a gush of euphony voluminously wells!
How it swells!
How it dwells
On the Future!—how it tells
Of the rapture that impels
To the swinging and the ringing

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Poem

Of the bells, bells, bells,
Of the bells, bells, bells, bells,
Bells, bells, bells—
To the rhyming and the chiming of the bells!

This selection is not copyrighted in the U.S.

Now answer these questions.

1. What type of figurative language is used by the poet in the first stanza?
2. What is the meaning of the poet's figurative language in the first stanza?
3. What is the meaning of this excerpt of the poem?

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Poem

Part 3

Read the excerpt of the poem “Purple Clover” by Emily Dickinson.

There is a flower that bees prefer,
And butterflies desire;
To gain the purple democrat
The humming-birds aspire.

Her face is rounder than the moon,
And ruddier than the gown
Of orchids in the pasture,
Or rhododendron worn.

She doth not wait for June;
Before the world is green
Her sturdy little countenance
Against the wind is seen,

And when the hills are full,
And newer fashions blow,
Doth not retract a single spice
For pang of jealousy.

The bravest of the host,
Surrendering the last,
Nor even of defeat aware
When cancelled by the frost.

This selection is not copyrighted in the U.S.

Now answer these questions.

1. What type of figurative language is used by the poet in the first stanza?
2. What is the meaning of the poet’s figurative language in the first stanza?
3. What is the meaning of this excerpt of the poem?

Part 4

On your paper write a sentence for each of the seven different types of figurative language described in this lesson. Identify the type of figurative language for each sentence.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Poem

Part 5

Now it is your turn to be a poet. Write a poem in the style of Poe or Dickinson. Make sure that you include at least two types of figurative language in your poem. Your poem will be evaluated using the following 3-point rubric. Write your poem on your paper.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of the Poem	Uses Figurative Language Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the poem exactly.	Uses several appropriate examples of figurative language in the poem.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the poem.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the poem but wanders a bit.	Uses a few appropriate examples of figurative language in the poem.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the poem.
1	Does not address the structure of the poem at all.	Does not use appropriate examples of figurative language in the poem.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Science Fiction

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- describe the style and genre characteristics of science fiction.
- write a science fiction story.

Materials

- writing paper
- markers

Background Information

Science fiction is a literary form that blends reality and science into a fictional story. It tells about imaginary events and typically involves science or technology. Many science fiction stories are set in the future or in an alternate universe. The story is the author's thoughts or ideas as to what the future might be or hopes it will be. The author usually takes aspects of regular life and then stretches them through a vivid imagination. Stories about space travel and UFOs blend fact and fiction into an exciting and wonder-filled story.

Many movies today are science fiction stories that spark the viewers' imagination and challenge what is thought to be real. Is time travel possible? Can dinosaurs be cloned? Is an asteroid headed toward the Earth? These types of science-based questions added to some imagination create good science fiction stories. Many times, in the future, science fiction does become science fact. One hundred years ago, a science fiction writer, Jules Verne, wrote books about ships that sail beneath the water and ships that sail to the stars. One hundred years later, submarines and space shuttles are part of our real world!

- **Setting:** The story might occur in the far future or distant past. The action may occur on another planet or on a spaceship.
- **Characters:** The characters may be aliens from outer space that visit us on Earth. Beings with non-human appearance and actions that possess human qualities are portrayed. Humans may be described as having superhuman powers.
- **Plot:** The storyline may involve technology not yet invented, or strange interactions and weird conflicts. Space exploration is described that goes far beyond the capabilities of man as we know it today.

Answer the following questions about the style and characteristics of science fiction stories.

1. The setting is always in the future.
 - a. a. true
 - b. false
2. Aliens are always the major characters.
 - a. a. true
 - b. false
3. People might be given incredible powers.
 - a. a. true
 - b. false
4. The plot might include technology that has yet to be invented.
 - a. a. true
 - b. false
5. The plot is always a mix of something that is known and something unknown.
 - a. true
 - b. false

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Science Fiction

Part 2

Read the adapted excerpt of the science fiction story “The Star” by H. G. Wells. While you are reading, take notes on the parts that show that it is a piece of science fiction writing.

The Star

It was on the first day of the year that the announcement was made, the motion of Neptune had become erratic. A new planet was rapidly growing larger and brighter, and its motion was quite different from the orderly progress of the planets. By the second day it was clearly visible to any instrument, as a speck with a barely sensible diameter, in the constellation Leo.

On the third day the newspaper readers were made aware of the real importance of this unusual appearance. “A Planetary Collision,” one London paper headed the news, and this strange new planet will probably collide with Neptune. The writers enlarged upon the topic; so that in most capitals of the world, there was an expectation, however vague, of some imminent phenomenon in the sky; and as night followed the sunset, thousands turned their eyes skyward to see—the old familiar stars.

A policeman saw the thing, the crowds in the markets stopped openmouthed, workmen, milkmen, drivers, patrols on their beats, laborers, all over the country it could be seen—and out at sea by seamen watching for the day—a great white star, come suddenly into the westward sky!

Brighter it was than any star; brighter than the evening star. It still glowed out white and large, no mere twinkling spot of light, but a small round clear shining disc. And in a hundred observatories there had been a hurrying, to gather photographic apparatus, to record this novel astonishing sight, the destruction of a world. For it was a sister planet of our earth, far greater than our earth, that had so suddenly flashed into flaming death. Neptune it was, had been struck, by the strange planet from outer space and the heat of the collision had turned two solid globes into one vast mass. Round the world that day, two hours before the dawn, went the great white star, fading only as it sank westward and the sun mounted above it. Everywhere people marveled at it.

And voice after voice repeated, “It is nearer,” and the clicking telegraph took that up, and it trembled along telephone wires.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Science Fiction

The next night the star rose later, for its eastward motion had carried it some way across Leo toward Virgo, and its brightness was so great that the sky became a luminous blue, and every star was hidden, save only Jupiter near the zenith.

The new planet and Neptune, locked in a fiery embrace, were whirling headlong, ever faster and faster toward the sun. Already every second this blazing mass flew a hundred miles, and every second its terrific velocity increased. As it flew now, indeed, it must pass a hundred million of miles wide of the earth and scarcely affect it. Every moment now the attraction between the fiery star and the greatest of the planets grew stronger. And the result of that attraction? Inevitably Jupiter would be deflected from its orbit into an elliptical path, and the burning star, swung by its attraction wide of its sunward rush, would perhaps collide with, and certainly pass very close to, our earth. Earthquakes, volcanic outbreaks, cyclones, sea waves, floods, and a steady rise in temperature were prophesied.

The star grew—it grew with a terrible steadiness, a little larger each hour until it had turned night into a second day. Had it come straight to the earth instead of in a curved path, had it lost no velocity to Jupiter, it must have leapt the gulf in a day, but as it was it took five days altogether to come by our planet. The next night it had become a third the size of the moon and the thaw was assured. It rose over America near the size of the moon, but blinding white to look at, and *hot*; and a breath of hot wind blew now with its rising and gathering strength. It shone intermittently through a driving reek of thunder-clouds, flickering violet lightning, and hail unprecedented.

And then came a wonder. It seemed to those who watched for the rising of the star that the world must have ceased its rotation. The people who had fled from the floods and the falling houses and sliding slopes watched for that rising in vain. Hour followed hour through a terrible suspense, and the star rose not. Once again people set their eyes upon the old constellations they had counted lost to them forever. In England it was hot and clear overhead, though the ground quivered perpetually. And when at last the great star rose near ten hours late, the sun rose close upon it, and in the center of its white heart was a disc of black.

People looking up, near blinded, at the star, saw that a black disc was creeping across the light. It was the moon, coming between the star and the earth. And then star, sun, and moon rushed together across the heavens.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Science Fiction

And though those who were still alive regarded that the star had passed. They gathered courage and slowly crept back to their ruined cities, buried granaries, and sodden fields. Such few ships as had escaped the storms of that time came to familiar ports. And as the storms subsided people perceived that everywhere the days were hotter than of yore, and the sun larger, and the moon, shrunk to a third of its former size, took now fourscore days between its new and new.

The Martian astronomers—for there are astronomers on Mars, although they are very different beings from men—were naturally interested by these things. They saw them from their standpoint. "Considering the mass and temperature of the missile that was flung through our solar system into the sun," one wrote, "it is astonishing what little damage the earth, which it missed so narrowly, has sustained. All the familiar markings and the masses of the seas remain intact, and indeed the only difference seems to be a shrinkage of the white discoloration (supposed to be frozen water) round either pole." Which only shows how small the vastest of human catastrophes may seem, at a distance of a few million miles.

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Now answer these questions.

1. What makes this fiction story science fiction?
2. Write one or two sentences that could be added to paragraphs 3 or 4 that would add an element of science fiction.
3. What is the main idea of this story?
 - a. People learned not to be afraid of lunar eclipses.
 - b. Catastrophes on earth are the result of other planets.
 - c. Martians have the ability to study and control the solar system.
 - d. The earth and its people were forever changed by a collision of planets.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Science Fiction

4. What caused Neptune to burst into flames?
 - a. It was hit by a star.
 - b. It went out of orbit.
 - c. It crashed into the sun.
 - d. It was hit by a new planet.
5. Which event in the story was something that is presently unknown?
 - a. outer-space astronomers
 - b. lunar and solar eclipses
 - c. changes to the polar caps
 - d. changes in the solar system

Part 3

Draw this story map on your paper. Then complete it, based on “The Star.”

Setting: Where: When:
Major Characters: Minor Characters:
Plot/Problem:
Event 1:
Event 2:
Event 3:
Outcome:

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Science Fiction

Part 4

Write a science fiction story on your writing paper. Make sure that your story includes the characteristics of science fiction. You may illustrate your story. Your writing will be evaluated using the following 3-point rubric.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Realistic Fiction

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- describe the style and characteristics of realistic fiction.
- write a realistic fiction story.

Materials

- highlighter
- writing paper
- markers

Background Information

Fiction is literature that describes imaginary people, places, and events with the purpose of entertaining the reader. **Realistic fiction** is a literary form in which the stories could happen in real life. They are based on everyday characters and events that could actually happen.

These points will help you to identify writing that is realistic fiction.

- **Characters:** The characters appear to be ordinary, real people. The characters usually change as a result of a problem and must resolve it.
- **Setting:** The place is either real, or it seems like a real place.
- **Plot:** The plot must be plausible and believable. There are usually problems, puzzling events, or dilemmas for characters to resolve. A reader will usually feel that the story really happened or may want to believe that it did.
- **Theme:** Themes that an author will write about include those that all people typically deal with, such as good versus bad. The events usually raise moral questions that the reader might face in real life.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Realistic Fiction

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

Part 1

Answer the following questions about the style and characteristics of realistic fiction stories.

1. The setting seems fantastical.
a. true b. false
2. The characters are based on historical individuals.
a. true b. false
3. The characters in realistic fiction often have experiences similar to the reader.
a. true b. false
4. The plot includes events that the reader can sense are true-to-life.
a. true b. false

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Realistic Fiction

Part 2

Read the story “The Power Plant.” While you are reading, take notes on the parts that show that it is a piece of realistic fiction.

The Power Plant

Austin and Ryan dragged the rubber raft to the edge of the creek. The water was racing by, and Ryan looked concerned. “I think we should try this on a day when the creek is lower,” he said.

“No way,” snapped Austin, “this is a perfect day for challenging the Power Plant.”

Ryan looked down the creek toward a pile of boulders known to the locals as the Power Plant—a menacing mass of rock that forced the water into a narrow chasm of rapids that dropped four feet into a small whirlpool. Experienced rafters thought the ride through the rapids was fast and furious. Not being an experienced rafter, Ryan thought it looked dangerous.

“How many times have you ridden through the Power Plant?” he asked.

“I’ve never ridden through it,” replied Austin, “but how hard can it be? People raft on this creek all the time.”

Ryan wanted to say that most of those people avoided the rapids, but he knew it was useless to argue with Austin.

The two boys lifted the raft into the creek and carefully slid into their positions. Ryan sat in the front because he was the smaller of the two boys—although he was thirteen, Ryan was only five feet tall and very thin. On the other hand, Austin was almost five feet, eight inches tall and husky, so he sat in the back of the raft to provide the hard paddling necessary to get through the rapids.

As they approached the Power Plant, Ryan began to feel stupid for having let Austin talk him into this. The water was splashing over the sides of the raft, and their desperate paddling seemed useless against the current.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Realistic Fiction

Austin stared at the fast-approaching boulders, suddenly aware that he had been foolish to attempt to ride these rapids. Without any hesitation, he pulled in his paddle and ducked down in the bottom of the raft.

Without Austin's paddling, the raft began to spin around. Ryan was too small to control it, but he knew if he followed Austin's lead, the raft would hit the boulders and capsize. Instead Ryan stuck his legs straight out from the raft and used his feet to push the raft away from the boulders as the whitewater carried them down the chasm. Without even thinking about it, Ryan made sure to give at his knees to cushion the force of hitting the wall of rock. He was glad that he had worn his sneakers. Austin, cowering in the bottom of the raft, was barefoot, of course.

The raft slowed down as it exited the rapids. Ryan had paddled it over to the shore before Austin had the nerve to lift up his head and look out. The color came back to his face, and he started to get excited. "We did it! We conquered the Power Plant!" Austin yelled to the world.

At a loss for words, Ryan just stared at Austin.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Realistic Fiction

Now answer these questions.

1. What makes this a realistic fiction story?
2. Write one or two sentences that could be added to paragraphs 1 or 2 that would add an element of realistic fiction.
3. What does Austin do when he sees the boulders in the rapids?
 - a. He paddles hard to help miss the rocks.
 - b. He screams for Ryan to paddle harder.
 - c. He ducks down in the bottom of the raft.
 - d. He holds tightly onto the sides of the raft.
4. Which sentence from the story foreshadows what might happen in the rapids?
 - a. He was glad that he had worn his sneakers.
 - b. Without Austin's paddling, the raft began to spin around.
 - c. Austin and Ryan dragged the rubber raft to the edge of the creek.
 - d. Not being an experienced rafter, Ryan thought it looked dangerous.
5. What do you predict that Ryan will do next time he goes rafting with Austin?
 - a. He will make sure that he sits in a different place in the raft.
 - b. He will ask Austin if he would be able to take another friend with them.
 - c. He will make sure that they go to a different part of the creek with fewer rapids.
 - d. He will ask Austin if they could repeat their ride down through the Power Plant.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Realistic Fiction

Part 3

On a piece of paper, complete a story map for “The Power Plant” like the one below.

Setting: Where:
When:
Major Characters:
Minor Characters:
Plot/Problem:
Event 1:
Event 2:
Event 3:
Outcome:

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Realistic Fiction

Part 4

Write a realistic fiction story on your writing paper. Make sure that your story includes the characteristics of realistic fiction. You may illustrate your story. Your writing will be evaluated using the following 3-point rubric.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Travel Brochure

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- analyze an author's use of descriptive detail.
- fill in a sensory detail chart.
- create a travel brochure for a favorite place, real or imagined.

Materials

- paper
- markers

Background Information

Good writers include descriptive details in order to help the reader “see,” “feel,” “taste,” “smell,” and “hear” the details in the story. Have you heard the saying “show, don’t tell” when you’re writing? This means that a writer should use words to paint a picture to make readers feel like they are actually in the story. Think about writing that you like and remember. It was probably full of descriptive details. In nonfiction writing, such as travel brochures or advertisements, writers will use descriptive details to persuade people to take a trip or buy a product.

Travel brochures are created by resorts, countries, states, and cities to inform potential visitors of the interesting and exciting highlights of the area. These include parks, beaches, museums, and culture of the area. Additionally, a travel brochure will include important information on travel to the area, accommodations, restaurants, and maps. These brochures are created in a variety of formats: tri-fold, one-page flyer, multi-page brochure, postcard, poster, or a folder with many of these formats. All of these will include sensory details to paint a picture of the destination that will entice the potential tourist to come and visit.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Travel Brochure

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

Part 1

Read the following travel brochure.

 Come and experience history from centuries past. The countryside and architecture will amaze your eyes throughout the day. You can enjoy art—old and new—in our myriad museums and galleries. Don't forget to stop and taste the delicious and varied foods from each country at meals. The aromas of garlic and butter, spicy meats, and fresh berries will tantalize you.	 Stand on a beach and let the soothing waters wash over your feet. Climb to the tops of mountains to gaze over the countryside. Listen to the pealing of church bells and the lively local music. Just make Europe you NEXT visit!
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Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Travel Brochure

Now answer these questions.

1. On your paper, fill in a chart like the following. Cite one detail that relates to each sense.

Sense	Detail from Brochure
Sight	
Smell	
Touch	
Taste	
Sound	

2. Which sense was used the most in the travel brochure?
3. Why do you think that this sense was used the most?

Part 2

What details could be added to make the travel brochure more vivid and paint a better picture for the potential visitor?

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Travel Brochure

Part 3

Read each pair of sentences and write the letter of the sentence that provides the most detail.

1. a. The logger spotted the gnarled tree towering over the others.
b. The logger saw the tall tree in the forest with many other trees.
2. a. They cautiously approached the darkened crumbling house.
b. As they approached the house they could see that it was empty.
3. a. They ate the popcorn as they watched the movie.
b. They ate the hot buttery popcorn as they watched the movie.
4. a. We played and were told to stop by the teacher.
b. We played roughly and were scolded loudly by the stern teacher.
5. a. Swiftly I flew down the mountainside on my cool snowboard.
b. You can go to the mountains to go snowboarding in the winter.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Travel Brochure

Part 4

On your paper, fill in a chart like the one below. Above your chart, write the name of your favorite vacation spot (real or imagined). Then, using the sensory detail chart, brainstorm some details that would describe your favorite vacation spot.

Favorite Vacation Spot

Sense	Details
Visual / See	
Sounds	
Tastes	
Textures / Touch	
Smells	

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Travel Brochure

Part 5

Now think about what a travel agent does. Think about what a vacation destination would do to convince people to come and stay. Create a travel brochure for your favorite place, whether it is real or imagined. The brochure can be a tri-fold, one-page flyer, multi-page brochure, postcard, poster, or a folder. You may use writing paper or paper and markers. Make sure that you include appropriate and descriptive details in your travel brochure. Your travel brochure will be evaluated using the following 3-point rubric.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of the Travel Brochure	Uses Details Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the travel brochure exactly.	Uses many appropriate details in the travel brochure.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the travel brochure.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the travel brochure but wanders a bit.	Uses some details in the travel brochure.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the travel brochure.
1	Does not address the structure of the travel brochure at all.	Does not use details in the travel brochure.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the travel brochure.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Movie Review

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- evaluate a movie review.
- analyze the writer's tone, voice, authority, and persuasiveness.
- write a review of a movie.

Materials

- writing paper

Background Information

A **movie review** is a short description aimed at providing potential viewers with information about the strengths and weaknesses of a movie. This helps potential viewers decide whether to see the movie. Writing a movie review is a great way to express your opinion about a movie. Learning how to write a movie review will enhance your appreciation of films.

A review should give enough details about the movie that the reader can make a wise decision. A review should not give anyway any essential details, such as twists in the plot or the ending. Movie reviews are typically 250 to 500 words and have the following format:

1. An **introduction** gives background information, such as the type of film, cast, director, main characters, and setting.
2. A **body** deals with key plot elements as well as comments on the editing, directing, lighting, music, and character development.
3. A **conclusion** is mainly your opinion about whether the film is worth watching. Include your opinions of the direction, script, actors, and photography. You should also give impartial details, and allow readers to make up their own minds. Opinions or claims should be supported to allow readers to determine whether they would agree with you.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Movie Review

Below are guidelines and tips for writing a good movie review.

1. Select the movie you want to review. First, get to know a little about it. What have the actors and director done previously? You might want to watch some of their prior movies. Are they Oscar winners? Are they known for a certain style? Is the movie based on a book or a historical event? Is it a remake or a sequel?
2. See the movie. You may even want to watch the movie a second time. Watching the movie a second time will help you recall more details.
3. Take notes during the film. Write down the names of the stars, director, and screenwriter. Note the running time and the rating.
4. Take time to let the film soak in. Think about it for a while before you begin writing. Let your likes or dislikes wear off a bit so your writing won't be too emotional.
5. Identify your audience. Is the review for a school newspaper, or is it for a film magazine? Ensure you report on the elements of the movie that matter to your likely audience.
6. Now you can write. Develop your opinion in one sentence. Your job as movie reviewer is to give your opinion of the movie. Your opinion will be the basis of your movie review.
7. Next, write the introduction. Most movie review readers like to be entertained, so think up a good line to hook the reader.
8. Let your draft sit for a few hours; then review and edit it.

Part 1

1. Taking notes during the movie will help you remember details.
 - a. true
 - b. false
2. A movie review is written for the purpose of getting people to see the movie.
 - a. true
 - b. false
3. In the body of the review only key plot elements are described.
 - a. true
 - b. false
4. Obtaining information about other films by the director will help you write the review.
 - a. true
 - b. false

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Movie Review

Part 2

Read the following movie review of *Harry Potter and the Deathly Hallows: Part 1*. Take notes on the key words that will help you evaluate and analyze the review.

Expectantly, I watched the first installment of the two-part conclusion to the Harry Potter series. The film finds Harry Potter walking away from his last year at Hogwarts to find and destroy the remaining Horcruxes, magical “soul containers” that will help him defeat Voldemort.

We are once again captivated by the appearance of the bespectacled wizard of Daniel Radcliffe, as well as Rupert Grint and Emma Watson. We have watched them grow up into adults. Their characters have artfully evolved with the aging process. This installment is craftily directed by the English filmmaker David Yates. He has directed the final four films of the Harry Potter series. All of these became instant blockbusters. There are some sequences of intense action violence and frightening images, but it does have the Common Sense rating of “OK for Kids 12+.”

The scenery in the movie is spectacular, the acting is outstanding, and the plot kept me on edge the entire time. The film ends in the middle of the novel and is in a place that makes sense. The director has everything in the movie that needs to be there. This movie is brilliant and a thrill to watch—but it’s a bit slow if you haven’t read the book. Oddly, there are fewer special effects and virtually none of the usual Hogwarts backdrops. This means that Harry, Hermione, and Ron have to carry more of the plot on their own.

The strength of the movie was in the cinematography: mostly dark, menacing, and generally scary. It has an excellent music soundtrack. The major weakness of the movie is simple: If you’re not a die-hard Harry Potter book series fan you will not understand the setting and problems in the film. The overall story is at a point now where there are so many characters, and so many events from the many prequel movies, that the plot in this particular movie can’t stand alone. However, even if you’re not sure about the story, the script and acting do make the movie interesting. In my opinion, this is the best Harry Potter movie so far.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Movie Review

Now answer these questions.

1. What is the main idea of this movie review?
 - e. Harry Potter ends Voldemort's bid for immortality.
 - f. Traveling through the England is romantic and breathtaking.
 - g. Life in the Gothic period was dark, romantic, and exceptional.
 - h. *Harry Potter and the Deathly Hallows: Part 1* is an excellent film.
2. Which genre of movie is reviewed?
 - a. action
 - b. comedy
 - c. drama
 - d. fantasy
3. What do you predict will be the best part of the next installment of the movie?
 - a. the collapse of Hogwarts
 - b. the fight scenes and special effects
 - c. the connection between the film and the novel
 - d. the character development of Harry Potter and his friends
4. How do you think this reviewer would rate the movie overall?
 - a. one star out of five
 - b. two stars out of five
 - c. three stars out of five
 - d. four stars out of five

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Movie Review

Part 3

On a piece of paper, fill in a chart like the one below to note the movie reviewer's claims in one column and supporting details or evidence in the other. If there are no supporting details to support a claim, write none in the column. Then answer the question that follows.

Claims	Supporting Details

1. Does the reviewer adequately support the claims in the review?
Explain. Write your response on your writing paper.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Movie Review

Part 4

Answer the following questions on your paper.

1. Does the reviewer reveal too much or too little about the film's plot?
Support your answer with specific details.
2. What is the reviewer's tone or voice in the review?
3. How does the reviewer establish his or her authority to write this review?
4. What details did the reviewer not include that are typically found in a movie review?
5. What additional questions do you have about the movie?

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Movie Review

Part 5

Write a movie review for a movie you've seen recently. Make sure that your review includes the elements of a movie review and support your claims and opinion. Your writing will be evaluated using the following 3-point rubric.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Music Review

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- evaluate a review of a concert or CD.
- analyze the writer's tone, voice, authority, and persuasiveness.
- write a review of a concert or CD.

Materials

- writing paper

Background Information

A **music review** is a short description aimed at providing potential listeners with information about the strengths and weaknesses of music. This helps possible listeners to decide whether they want to listen to the music and/or attend a concert. Writing a music review is a great way to express your opinion of music. Learning how to write a music review will enhance your appreciation of different types of music.

A review should give enough details about the music so that the reader can make a wise decision. Music reviews are typically 250 to 500 words and have the following format:

1. An **introduction** gives background information, such as the name of the singer(s) and band members, what type of music they have performed in previous albums, how many tracks the current CD has, and some of the song titles. If the review is about a concert, you describe the location, the audience, how many songs were played, and other details that might be interesting to the reader. Think about the questions: who, what, when, where, and why.
2. A main **body** deals with specific songs that you feel strongly about and which songs you disliked. Bring your impressions and point of view alive. Describe the music at the concert performance.
3. A **conclusion** is mainly your opinion about whether the CD or concert is worth listening to and buying/attending. Write specifically about the CD or concert you are reviewing, not as much about the band itself or its past albums. You should give impartial details, and allow readers to make up their own minds. Support your opinions and claims with factual information that back up your opinions.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Music Review

Below are guidelines and tips for writing a good music review.

1. Select the music you want to review or choose a concert to attend. First, get to know a little about the music and the band. What has the band done previously? Perhaps listen to some of their prior CDs. Are they Grammy winners? Are they known for a certain style?
2. Listen to the CD a few times. Listening to the music a few times will help you feel the tempo and rhythm, understand the lyrics, and appreciate other elements of CD.
3. Take notes while listening to the music. Study the cover and inside notes. Note the running time and title of the tracks. Note the tracks that stand out for being great or terrible.
4. Take time to let the music soak in. Think about it for a while before you begin writing. Let your likes or dislikes wear off a bit so your writing won't be too emotional.
5. Identify your audience. Is it for a school newspaper review or is it for music buffs? Ensure you report on the elements of the music that matter to your likely audience.
6. Now you can write. Develop your opinion in one sentence. Your job as music reviewer is to give your opinion of the music. This may come down to the typical "thumbs up" or "three stars out of five." Develop your opinion that will be the basis of your music review.
7. Next write the introduction. Most music review readers like to be entertained, so think up a good line to hook the reader.
8. Let your review sit for a few hours, then review it and edit.

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

Answer the following questions about the elements of a music review.

1. Taking notes while listening to the music will help you remember specific details of the songs.
 - a. true
 - b. false
2. A music review is written for the purpose to get people to buy the CD or to attend the concert.
 - a. true
 - b. false
3. The reviewer's opinion is always included in the introduction.
 - a. true
 - b. false
4. In the body of the review all CD tracks are discussed.
 - a. true
 - b. false
5. Obtaining information about other CDs by the musicians will help you write the review.
 - a. true
 - b. false

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Music Review

Part 2

Read the following music review of 4 by Beyoncé. Take notes on key words that will help you answer questions that evaluate and analyze the review.

Just as the label states, this is album number four for Beyoncé and could be considered her best work to date. If you are a fan of '70s, '80s, or '90s music, then this CD has something for you. If you like vintage soul, hard rock, reggae, adult, or contemporary, then you will find something to enjoy. The tempo of the songs is mainly mid-tempos with ballads and a few up-tempos. Her vocals have improved vastly since her last CD release.

Production is smart, smooth, and varied. The attention to detail is amazing, like one of those darker albums by Janet Jackson or Christina Aguilera. This album, however, is not dark. You will have to listen multiple times to notice every little touch that is in the background. To get to this end product, she apparently recorded 72 tracks and she took time to achieve this magic in the 13 songs. She was guided by producers and writers who are some of the most experienced, such as Rodney Jerkins and Tricky Stewart. She also was guided by MIA producers Diplo and Switch and the Sleigh Bells. Frank Ocean of Odd Future wrote "I Miss You," Grammy Award winning Diane Warren wrote "I was Here," and chart-topping songwriter/producer Ester Dean wrote "Start Over." Andre 3000 is the accompanist on "Party." What a combination of talent and influence for one CD!

There are love songs: "1+1," "I Miss You", and "I Was Here," which are not my top picks since she just seems to be repeating themes and melodies from her other CDs. Other tracks are just playful: "Best Thing I Never Had," "Love on Top," and "Countdown." If you want thoughtful tracks listen to: "I Care" or "Start Over"—these two just went deep into my soul.

All in all, this CD is not only a work of art but it's a big surprise and treat for Beyoncé's loyal fans who have been waiting for her to get serious with her music and give it her all. I loved most of tracks the first time I heard them, but some of them might have to grow on you.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Music Review

Now answer these questions.

1. Which genre of music is reviewed?
 - i. blues
 - j. country
 - k. hip-hop
 - l. pop
2. Which song does the reviewer like the best?
 - a. "1+1"
 - b. "Countdown"
 - c. "I Miss You"
 - d. "Start Over"
3. Which song does the reviewer like the least?
 - a. "I Care"
 - b. "I Miss You"
 - c. "Love on Top"
 - d. "Start Over"
4. What is the reviewer's overall rating of the CD?
 - a. one star out of five
 - b. two stars out of five
 - c. three stars out of five
 - d. four stars out of five

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Music Review

Part 3

On your paper, fill in a two-column chart like the one below to note claims in one column and supporting details or evidence in the other. If there are no supporting details to support a claim, write “none” in the column. Then answer the question that follows.

Claims	Supporting Details

1. Does the reviewer adequately support claims in the review? Explain. Write your response on your writing paper.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Music Review

Part 4

Answer the following questions on your writing paper.

1. Does the reviewer reveal too much or too little about the CD? Support your answer with specific details.
2. What is the reviewer's tone or voice in the review?
3. How does the reviewer establish his or her authority to write this review?
4. What details did the reviewer not include that are typically found in a music review?
5. What additional questions do you have about the music?

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Music Review

Part 5

Write a music review of a concert or CD on your writing paper. Make sure that your review includes the elements of a music review and support your claims and opinion. Your writing will be evaluated using the following 3-point rubric.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Topic	Supports the Topic Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the writing exactly to the topic. Does not shift focus.	Uses several appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the writing.
2	Does a good job staying on topic. May wander or shift focus slightly.	Uses a few characteristics of the genre to support the main topic.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the writing.
1	Does not address the topic at all.	Does not use appropriate characteristics of the genre to support the topic.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling in the writing.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Compare Genres / Themes

Objectives

The student will be able to:

- compare and contrast the use of literary form to convey a theme.
- write a play scene or personal narrative that conveys the same theme.

Materials

- writing paper

Background Information

Literary forms are approached and read differently. Each literary form incorporates different literary techniques and devices.

This chart will help you to distinguish a few of the different literary forms.

Literary Forms	Definition and Features
Fable	a short tale that teaches a moral lesson, often with animals or inanimate objects as characters
Folktale	a story passed on traditionally and considered to be false or based on superstition
Legend	a story about a heroic figure
Myth	a story dealing with supernatural beings or events, explaining aspects of the natural world
Personal Narrative	a writing that offers details and a personal opinion about an event in the writer's life or experiences
Play	a literary work written for performance on the stage
Poem	a piece of literature often written in meter or verse
Short Story	a short piece of prose fiction, having few characters and aiming at unity of effect

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Compare Genres / Themes

Critical reading of different literary forms includes making **comparisons** and **contrasts**. Comparisons show similarities between people, objects, and events. Contrasts show the differences. Being able to compare and contrast different literary forms requires you to understand the different features and how the writer used that literary form to accomplish a specific purpose.

Many stories, plays, and poems have a central idea about life, or **theme**. Because the writer usually doesn't state the theme directly, you will have to discover it on your own.

These steps can help you determine the theme.

- First, think about the title. It may provide a clue to the characters and a problem that they need to solve.
- Second, think about the characters. Think about their actions, thoughts, and feelings. What do the characters talk about with each other? What is their main problem? What do they learn from solving the problem?
- Third, think about the passage's events and setting.
- Finally, look for an idea that is repeated throughout the passage.

Reading for SylvanSync™

Grades 6–8

Compare Genres / Themes

Activity

Complete the activities that follow on a separate sheet of paper.

Part 1

Match the literary form on the left with the features on the right.

- | | |
|--------------------------|--|
| _____ short story | a. literature often written in verse |
| _____ poem | b. a writing of the writer's life |
| _____ folktale | c. a work for performance on stage |
| _____ personal narrative | d. a narrative that has few characters |
| _____ play | e. a story based on superstition |

Part 2

On your paper, write the answers to the following questions.

1. What is the difference between a play and a poem?
2. What is the difference between a short story and a personal narrative?
3. How are a fable and a myth similar?
4. How are a legend and folktale similar?
5. Compare and contrast a biography and an autobiography.

Part 3

On your paper, write the type of story that you might read that would have the following themes.

1. Crime does not pay.
2. Persistence and hard work will payoff in the end.
3. You should always stand up for what you believe is right.
4. Patience and kindness are important.
5. Do what you say you are going to do.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Compare Genres / Themes

Part 4

Read the poem “Hope” by Emily Dickinson and the short story “Gram’s Old Farmhouse.”

Hope

Hope is the thing with feathers
That perches in the soul,
And sings the tune without the words,
And never stops at all,

And sweetest in the gale is heard:
And sore must be the storm
That could abash the little bird
That kept so many warm.

I’ve heard it in the chilliest land,
And on the strangest sea;
Yet, never, in extremity,
It asked a crumb of me.

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Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Compare Genres / Themes

Gram's Old Farmhouse

The family gathered noisily in the crowded kitchen of Gram's old farmhouse. Gram had prepared a turkey and vegetables, and the children were seated around the table according to age. For a while, a hungry silence filled the house as everyone ate. Apple cider was passed around, and the sweet potato pie was gone in minutes.

Gram rose slowly from her place at the head of the table, looked lovingly at her large family and announced, "My old bones have been saying things to me lately, and they say I can't take care of this big, old place. I've decided to move to the Breakers. It is an old schoolhouse that has been made into small apartments. I have faith that you all will respect my decision. It is my hope that we will continue to be together as a family for these gatherings and that you will all come and visit."

Quiet filled the room. Everyone started objecting. They all had reasons she should stay. But Gram was determined to sell the farm and move. She had a clear vision of her future, and how she hoped to live it.

The talking lasted well after the last bite of dessert. Gram refused to give up, and the rest of the family refused to back down. Everyone was surprised when Bobby, one of the youngest, spoke up.

"Why can't Gram do what's best for her?" he asked.

The conversation at the table came to a halt. The rest of the family was embarrassed. "I'm sorry," Gram's oldest son spoke, "of course, Bobby's right. We'll just have you to our house for Sunday dinners, and we'll visit you all the time." One by one, Gram's family agreed to support her decision to sell the farm.

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Compare Genres / Themes

Now answer these questions on your paper.

1. Compare and contrast the two literary forms that you have just read.
2. What is the theme of these passages, and how do these two literary works develop the theme similarly?
3. How do they develop the theme differently?
4. Which literary form do you like better and why?
5. What line could be added to the poem or a sentence to the story to support the theme?

Reading for SylvanSync™
Grades 6–8
Compare Genres / Themes

Part 5

Write a scene for a play or a personal narrative that conveys the theme of hope. Your writing will be evaluated using the following 3-point rubric. Write your piece on your paper.

Writing Rubric

Score	Addresses the Structure of the Literary Form	Develops Theme Appropriately	Uses Correct Grammar, Capitalization, Punctuation, and Spelling
3	Targets the structure of the literary form exactly.	Develops the theme in the literary form.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout the literary form.
2	Does a good job of targeting the structure of the literary form but wanders a bit.	Partially develops a theme in the literary form.	Capitalization, punctuation, and spelling are used correctly throughout some of the literary form.
1	Does not address the structure of the literary form at all.	Does not develop any theme in the literary form.	There is no attempt at correct capitalization, punctuation, and spelling literary form.